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5 worksheets

Worksheets for employees

Practical worksheets for working with AI in a smart and sustainable way.

contents

01 **Weekly planner with focus blocks**
Plan your week in blocks: focus, AI work, meetings, breaks and wrapping up.

02 **End-of-day checklist**
A fixed 15-minute wrap-up ritual, so your head lets go of work too.

03 **AI output check card**
Decide for each type of AI output how closely you check it, and who looks with you when in doubt.

04 **Four-week AI practice plan**
Build confidence with AI in your own work over four weeks, one task at a time.

05 **Job crafting worksheet**
Steer your tasks, contacts, view of your work and use of AI towards what gives you energy.

How to use these worksheets. Each worksheet has two parts: first the explanation with the method and an example, then a page to fill in yourself. Print the fill-in page as often as you like.

For use within your own organisation. Do not resell or share publicly.

Worksheet 01

Weekly planner with focus blocks

Plan your week in blocks rather than loose tasks. That gives deep work room to breathe again, keeps AI work contained, and makes recovery as fixed as any meeting.

Time	When	What you get
15 minutes on Monday, 5 minutes on Friday	Every week, four weeks in a row to make it a habit	More real focus time and fewer fragmented days

Why it works

Every time you switch between tasks, part of your attention stays stuck on the previous one. With AI tools you switch more often than you think: prompting, reading, checking and back to your own work.

By batching AI work and protecting focus time, you switch less often and have more energy left at the end of the day. Short screen-free breaks have been shown to boost energy and reduce fatigue.

The five types of block

Block	What you do
F · Focus	60 to 90 minutes on your most important work, with notifications off and no AI chat open. Two per day at most.
A · AI work	Prompting, reading and checking AI output, batched into one or two fixed blocks a day.
M · Meetings	Appointments and conversations, ideally back to back so your focus time stays intact.
B · Break	Five to ten minutes away from the screen: walk, get a drink, step outside. Between every two blocks.
W · Wrap-up	Fifteen minutes at the end of the day to clear your head.

Example: a week in the life of Sanne, marketer

	Morning	Afternoon	End of day
Monday	Focus, AI work	Meetings, break, AI work	Wrap-up
Tuesday	Focus, break, focus	AI work, meetings	Wrap-up
Wednesday	Meetings, AI work	Focus, break	Wrap-up
Thursday	Focus, break, focus	AI work	Wrap-up
Friday	AI work, meetings	Focus	Wrap-up

Tuesday and Thursday worked best: two focus blocks in the morning, AI work only after lunch.

Based on: Leroy (2009) on attention residue; Albulescu et al. (2022) on micro-breaks; Sonnentag and Fritz (2007) on recovery

Worksheet 01 · To fill in

Weekly planner with focus blocks

Name _____ Date _____

	Morning	Afternoon	End of day
Monday			
Tuesday			
Wednesday			
Thursday			
Friday			

Your focus goal and your three most important tasks of the week

A plan per part of the day, with an energy score every evening

A Friday look-back in three questions

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Worksheet 02

End-of-day checklist

Recovery only starts once your head stops working too. A fixed wrap-up moment helps, especially on days when not everything is finished. Give it fifteen minutes every working day.

Time	When	What you get
10 to 15 minutes per working day	At the end of every working day, at home too	Calmer evenings and a flying start the next morning

Why it works

In research, mentally detaching from work is strongly linked to less exhaustion, better sleep and greater wellbeing.

Unfinished tasks keep buzzing around your head, but that largely stops once you write down a concrete plan for tomorrow. A fixed closing ritual also works as a signal to yourself: work is done for today.

The wrap-up ritual in five steps

0–3 min	**Look back** Write down what you finished today, small things included. It gives you a sense of progress.
3–6 min	**Loose ends** Note what isn't finished yet, with the first step for tomorrow next to each point.
6–9 min	**AI and tabs** Close AI chats and browser tabs. Anything you still want to check goes on your list, not in your head.
9–12 min	**Tomorrow** Check tomorrow's calendar and pick your first focus block.
12–15 min	**Off** Turn off notifications from work apps until the next working day. Close with a fixed final gesture.

Example: if-then plans that work

An if-then plan links a situation to what you will do in it. That way, you don't have to decide in the moment.

- If I see a work notification after 6 pm, then I leave my phone in the hallway and look at it at 9 am tomorrow.
- If I get an idea for a prompt in the evening, then I put it in my notes and don't open an AI tool.
- If I close my laptop, then I take a walk around the block.

Based on: Sonnentag and Fritz (2007); Wendsche and Lohmann-Haislah (2017); Masicampo and Baumeister (2011)

Worksheet 02 · To fill in

End-of-day checklist

Name

Date

Your own wrap-up ritual and closing gesture

What you no longer do after work, and your if-then plans

A four-week tracker with a weekly calm score

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Worksheet 03

AI output check card

Checking everything isn't sustainable; checking nothing is risky. With this card, you decide once for each type of output how closely you check it, and who takes a second look when you're unsure.

Time	When	What you get
20 minutes to fill in, then update monthly	On your own or with your team	Less doubt, less double work and fewer mistakes slipping through

Why it works

People who trust automation start checking less carefully: that's called automation bias. People who want to check everything in detail end up mentally exhausted.

In recent research, overseeing AI output turned out to be the most draining part of AI work. A fixed rule for each type of output removes the doubt, so you spend your attention where it matters.

Set the level of checking

For each type of output, ask two questions: how bad would a mistake be, and how often does this tool get it wrong?

	Small chance of a mistake	**Large chance of a mistake**
Large impact of a mistake	Full: check everything yourself before it goes out.	Full, four eyes: check everything, and a colleague reviews it too.
Small impact of a mistake	Light: skim for anything odd. Use freely.	Spot check: check thoroughly about one in five times.

Rules of thumb

- Always check facts, names, numbers, quotes and sources, whatever the level.
- Can't judge something properly yourself? Then the check belongs with someone who can.
- Keep track of the mistakes you find for a week. You'll learn where a tool is weak and can adjust the level.

Example

Type of output	Impact	Chance	Level	Who checks
Quote or email to a client	Large	Small	Full	Me
Figures in a monthly report	Large	Large	Four eyes	Controller
Summary of an internal meeting	Small	Large	Spot check	Me
Ideas for a brainstorm	Small	Small	Light	Nobody

Based on: Parasuraman and Manzey (2010); Bedard et al. (2026), Harvard Business Review

Worksheet 03 · To fill in

AI output check card

Name _____ Date _____

Type of output	Impact	Chance	Level	Who checks

Your own check card for each type of output

A mistake log to spot patterns

The date you'll next update the card

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Worksheet 04

Four-week AI practice plan

Confidence in your own ability doesn't come from a training session alone, but from small successes in your own work. Take half an hour each week for one step.

Time	When	What you get
30 minutes a week, for four weeks	When AI is new in your work, or when you're unsure whether you're doing it right	One task you do confidently and faster with AI, and a way of working for your team

Why it works

Self-confidence grows mainly through your own successes, and by seeing how others approach something.

That matters for the quality of your work too: people with more confidence in their own abilities think more critically about AI output, while people who mostly trust the tool become less sharp.

The four weeks

Week 1	**Pick one task and compare** Pick a recurring task AI could help with. Do it once with AI and once without, and note the time and quality. Ask: what got faster, and what got worse?
Week 2	**Learn from a colleague** Ask a colleague how they tackle the same kind of task with AI and adopt one of their habits. Ask: what are they doing that I'm not yet?
Week 3	**Test the limits** Deliberately look for where the tool gets your task wrong. That teaches you when you can and can't trust the output. Ask: what do I always need to watch out for?
Week 4	**Make it stick** Write down your way of working in five lines and share it with your team. Ask: what should a new colleague know?

Example: Daan, policy adviser

Task: minutes of the weekly team meeting.

- Week 1: 45 minutes without AI, 15 minutes with AI. But the decisions weren't captured properly.
- Week 3: the tool misses who is doing what. So I always check the action points myself.
- Confidence: from 4 to 8.

Based on: Bandura (1997) on self-efficacy; Lee et al. (2025), Microsoft and Carnegie Mellon

Worksheet 04 · To fill in

Four-week AI practice plan

Name _____ Date _____

Your task, and your confidence now and after four weeks

One question to answer each week

Your way of working in five lines, to share with your team

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Worksheet 05

Job crafting worksheet

Job crafting means adjusting your work a little yourself: what you do, who you do it with, and how you see it. AI is changing your tasks anyway. This worksheet helps you have a say in which direction.

Time	When	What you get
30 minutes	Every quarter, or when AI noticeably changes your work	One small change that makes your work more energising

Why it works

In research, employees who shape their own tasks, contacts and view of their work are more engaged and less exhausted. It's not about big changes: small adjustments to how you fill your day already make a difference.

Right now, as AI takes over tasks, is the moment to choose consciously what you want to keep.

The four dials you can turn

Tasks

What you do, and how much. For example: hand repetitive work to AI, freeing up time for work that energises you.

Contacts

Who you work with, and how often. For example: find a regular sparring partner to review AI output together.

View of your work

How you see your work. For example: seeing your role as the final editor of AI work, rather than someone who makes everything from scratch.

Use of AI

What you do and don't use AI for. For example: deliberately keeping some work manual because you enjoy it or want to grow in it.

Example: Fatima, HR adviser

Gives energy

Conversations with managers, puzzling over tricky cases.

Costs energy

Rewriting every AI-written job ad three times.

My small step

I write one good job ad as an example for the AI, and agree with my manager to keep one afternoon a week free for cases.

Based on: Wrzesniewski and Dutton (2001); Tims, Bakker and Derks (2012); Bakker and Demerouti (2017)

Worksheet 05 · To fill in

Job crafting worksheet

Name

Date

What gives you energy and what costs energy

For each dial, what you want to change, with a first step and a moment

Your small step as an if-then plan, and a look back after a month

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